DIGITAL MARKETING TRACK

Basic Conversion Tracking Plan

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Tools: Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager, Google Sheets

1. Objective

The aim of this task is to understand how a business measures outcomes on its website. Instead of only counting visits, a tracking plan decides **which visitor actions actually matter to the business**, gives each one a clear event name and rules for when it fires, and explains how it is set up in Google Tag Manager so the data lands correctly in Google Analytics 4.

2. Business and goals

A fictional direct-to-consumer (D2C) online tea store based in Hyderabad. It sells packaged teas and gift boxes to consumers, and takes bulk / corporate-gifting orders through an enquiry form.

• Increase online revenue from tea orders

• Generate bulk and corporate-gifting leads

• Grow a repeat-customer base (accounts + newsletter)

3. Primary conversions vs micro-conversions

Primary conversions are actions that directly create business value: a sale, a qualified lead, or a new customer account. These are marked as **Key events** in GA4 and are the only ones imported into Google Ads for bidding. **Micro-conversions** are smaller steps that show intent or engagement (adding to cart, clicking WhatsApp, joining the newsletter). They are tracked so we can find where people drop off, but they are *not* counted as conversions, because counting them would inflate results and confuse ad bidding.

4. Conversion list

ID	Conversion	GA4 event	Type	What counts	Where it happens	Key event?
C1	Online purchase	purchase	Primary	Customer completes payment for an order	Order confirmation page (/order-success)	Yes
C2	Corporate / bulk enquiry	generate_lead	Primary	Visitor submits the corporate-gifting enquiry form successfully	/corporate-gifting form	Yes
C3	Account sign-up	sign_up	Primary	Visitor creates a customer account	/signup and checkout page	Yes
M1	Begin checkout	begin_checkout	Micro	Visitor clicks 'Checkout' from the cart	/cart -> /checkout	No
M2	Add to cart	add_to_cart	Micro	Visitor adds a product to the cart	Product pages, collection pages	No
M3	Add shipping info	add_shipping_info	Micro	Visitor submits delivery address step	/checkout (step 1)	No
M4	Add payment info	add_payment_info	Micro	Visitor selects a payment method	/checkout (step 2)	No
M5	Newsletter sign-up	newsletter_signup	Micro	Visitor subscribes to the newsletter	Footer form, exit pop-up	No
M6	WhatsApp chat click	whatsapp_click	Micro	Visitor clicks the WhatsApp chat button	Floating button on all pages	No
M7	Click to call	click_to_call	Micro	Visitor taps the phone number	Header, contact page (mobile)	No
M8	View product	view_item	Micro	Visitor views a product detail page	/product/*	No
M9	Catalog download	file_download	Micro	Visitor downloads the wholesale catalog PDF	/corporate-gifting	No
M10	Site search	search	Micro	Visitor uses the site search	Header search bar	No

Green = primary conversion, orange = micro-conversion.

5. Event definitions

Event name	Fires when	Parameters	Example values	Implementation	Category
purchase	dataLayer push after payment gateway confirms success (fires once per order on /order-success)	transaction_id, value, currency, tax, shipping, coupon, items[]	ORD-10482, 1249.00, INR, 59.47, 50.00, CHAI10, [{item_id:'TEA-MAS-250', item_name:'Masala Chai 250g', price:399, quantity:2}]	GTM: Custom Event tag	GA4 recommended (ecommerce)
generate_lead	dataLayer push only after the server returns success for the enquiry form (not on button click)	form_name, lead_type, value, currency	corporate_gifting, bulk_order, 500, INR	GTM: Custom Event tag	Recommended
sign_up	dataLayer push after account is created successfully	method	email | google	GTM: Custom Event tag	Recommended
begin_checkout	dataLayer push when the checkout page loads from the cart	value, currency, coupon, items[]	1249.00, INR, CHAI10, [items]	GTM: Custom Event tag	GA4 recommended (ecommerce)
add_to_cart	dataLayer push when 'Add to cart' succeeds	value, currency, items[]	399.00, INR, [items]	GTM: Custom Event tag	GA4 recommended (ecommerce)
add_shipping_info	dataLayer push when address step is submitted	value, currency, shipping_tier, items[]	1249.00, INR, standard, [items]	GTM: Custom Event tag	GA4 recommended (ecommerce)
add_payment_info	dataLayer push when payment method is chosen	value, currency, payment_type, items[]	1249.00, INR, upi, [items]	GTM: Custom Event tag	GA4 recommended (ecommerce)
newsletter_signup	dataLayer push after newsletter form success	form_location	footer | exit_popup	GTM: Custom Event tag	Custom
whatsapp_click	GTM Just Links trigger: Click URL contains 'wa.me'	link_url, page_location	https://wa.me/91XXXXXXXXXX, /product/masala-chai	GTM: Link Click trigger	Custom
click_to_call	GTM Just Links trigger: Click URL starts with 'tel:'	link_url	tel:+91XXXXXXXXXX	GTM: Link Click trigger	Custom
view_item	dataLayer push on product page load	value, currency, items[]	399.00, INR, [items]	GTM: Custom Event tag	GA4 recommended (ecommerce)
file_download	Automatic - GA4 Enhanced Measurement detects .pdf link clicks	file_name, file_extension, link_url	leafloop-wholesale-catalog, pdf, /files/catalog.pdf	GA4 Enhanced Measurement (no tag needed)	Automatic
search	Automatic - GA4 Enhanced Measurement reads ?q= from search URL	search_term	darjeeling green tea	GA4 Enhanced Measurement (no tag needed)	Automatic

Naming rules: GA4 recommended event names are used wherever one exists (purchase, generate_lead, sign_up, add_to_cart...), so GA4's built-in ecommerce and lead reports work automatically. Custom events use snake_case and stay under 40 characters. Custom parameters (form_name, lead_type, form_location, method) must be registered as event-scoped custom dimensions in GA4 to appear in reports.

6. Tracking plan (Google Tag Manager setup)

GTM tag	Tag type	Trigger	Trigger condition	Variables / data	Key event?	Notes
GA4 - Config (Google tag)	Google Tag	All Pages	Page View - all pages	{{GA4 Measurement ID}}	-	Base tag. Loads GA4 on every page.
GA4 - Event - purchase	GA4 Event	CE - purchase	Custom Event: event equals purchase	Ecommerce data from dataLayer	Yes	Tick 'Send Ecommerce data'. Dedupe on transaction_id.
GA4 - Event - generate_lead	GA4 Event	CE - generate_lead	Custom Event: event equals generate_lead	{{DLV - form_name}}, {{DLV - lead_type}}, {{DLV - value}}	Yes	Fire on server success only.
GA4 - Event - sign_up	GA4 Event	CE - sign_up	Custom Event: event equals sign_up	{{DLV - method}}	Yes	
GA4 - Event - begin_checkout	GA4 Event	CE - begin_checkout	Custom Event: event equals begin_checkout	Ecommerce data from dataLayer	No	Funnel step 3
GA4 - Event - add_to_cart	GA4 Event	CE - add_to_cart	Custom Event: event equals add_to_cart	Ecommerce data from dataLayer	No	Funnel step 2
GA4 - Event - add_shipping_info	GA4 Event	CE - add_shipping_info	Custom Event: event equals add_shipping_info	Ecommerce data from dataLayer	No	Funnel step 4
GA4 - Event - add_payment_info	GA4 Event	CE - add_payment_info	Custom Event: event equals add_payment_info	Ecommerce data from dataLayer	No	Funnel step 5
GA4 - Event - view_item	GA4 Event	CE - view_item	Custom Event: event equals view_item	Ecommerce data from dataLayer	No	Funnel step 1
GA4 - Event - newsletter_signup	GA4 Event	CE - newsletter_signup	Custom Event: event equals newsletter_signup	{{DLV - form_location}}	No	Register form_location as custom dimension
GA4 - Event - whatsapp_click	GA4 Event	LC - WhatsApp	Just Links: Click URL contains wa.me	{{Click URL}}	No	Enable built-in Click variables
GA4 - Event - click_to_call	GA4 Event	LC - Phone	Just Links: Click URL starts with tel:	{{Click URL}}	No	Mostly mobile traffic
(none - automatic)	GA4 Enhanced Measurement	-	GA4 Admin > Data streams > Enhanced measurement ON	-	No	Covers file_download, search, scroll, outbound clicks

How the data flows: the website pushes an event into the *dataLayer* → a GTM Custom Event trigger listens for that event name → the GA4 Event tag sends it to GA4 with its parameters → in GA4 the primary events are marked as Key events. WhatsApp and phone clicks need no website code: GTM's built-in Link Click trigger catches them. File downloads, site search and scroll come from GA4 Enhanced Measurement.

7. Conversion priorities

Rank	Event	Tier	Why it matters	Key event?	Value used	Import to Google Ads?
1	purchase	Tier 1 - Primary (revenue)	Direct revenue. Main KPI for ROAS and Google Ads bidding.	Yes	Actual order value	Yes - primary
2	generate_lead	Tier 1 - Primary (lead)	A single corporate order can be 20-50x a normal order.	Yes	500 INR (estimated)	Yes - primary
3	sign_up	Tier 2 - Secondary	Accounts drive repeat purchases and remarketing lists.	Yes	No value	Yes - secondary (observe only)
4	begin_checkout	Tier 3 - High-intent micro	Strongest sign of buying intent; used to find checkout drop-off.	No	-	No
5	add_to_cart	Tier 3 - High-intent micro	Shows product interest; base for cart-abandonment remarketing.	No	-	No
6	add_payment_info	Tier 3 - High-intent micro	Shows payment step friction (UPI / card / COD).	No	-	No
7	add_shipping_info	Tier 3 - High-intent micro	Shows address-step drop-off (e.g. shipping cost shock).	No	-	No
8	whatsapp_click	Tier 4 - Engagement micro	Common way Indian shoppers ask questions before buying.	No	-	No
9	newsletter_signup	Tier 4 - Engagement micro	Builds an owned email audience.	No	-	No
10	click_to_call	Tier 4 - Engagement micro	Offline intent, mainly bulk buyers.	No	-	No
11	file_download	Tier 4 - Engagement micro	Catalog download = early B2B interest.	No	-	No
12	view_item	Tier 5 - Diagnostic	Top-of-funnel product interest.	No	-	No
13	search	Tier 5 - Diagnostic	Shows what customers look for (and can't find).	No	-	No

Only Tier 1 events are used as primary conversions for Google Ads bidding. sign_up is a Key event in GA4 but is imported to Ads as secondary, so ads optimise for revenue and leads rather than free sign-ups.

8. Implementation steps

1. Create a GA4 property and a Web data stream; copy the Measurement ID (G-XXXXXXXXXX). Turn on Enhanced Measurement.
2. Create a GTM web container and add the GTM snippet to every page of the site.
3. Import gtm/gtm-container-import.json (Admin > Import Container > Merge) and replace G-XXXXXXXXXX in the 'GA4 Measurement ID' variable.
4. Ask the developer to add the dataLayer pushes from gtm/datalayer-snippets.js at the right moments (e.g. purchase only after payment success).
5. Test everything in GTM Preview mode and GA4 DebugView using the QA checklist below, then Submit / Publish the container.
6. In GA4 Admin > Events, mark purchase, generate_lead and sign_up as Key events. Register custom dimensions form_name, lead_type, form_location and method.
7. Build a funnel exploration in GA4: view_item > add_to_cart > begin_checkout > add_shipping_info > add_payment_info > purchase.

9. QA / testing checklist

Test step	Expected result
Open GTM Preview (Tag Assistant) on the site	Tag Assistant connects and shows 'Container Loaded'
Load any page	'GA4 - Config' fires on Page View
View a product	view_item fires with items[] filled
Add a product to cart	add_to_cart fires once with value + currency
Go to checkout and complete steps	begin_checkout, add_shipping_info, add_payment_info fire in order
Complete a test order	purchase fires ONCE with a transaction_id; refresh page does not fire it again
Submit corporate form with valid data	generate_lead fires only after success message
Submit corporate form with an error	generate_lead does NOT fire
Click WhatsApp and phone links	whatsapp_click and click_to_call fire with link_url
Check GA4 > Admin > DebugView	All events appear with correct parameters
Mark key events in GA4	purchase, generate_lead, sign_up toggled as Key events
Register custom dimensions	form_name, lead_type, form_location, method registered (event scope)

10. Key learnings

• Measure business outcomes (sales, leads), not just page views or clicks.

• Separating primary conversions from micro-conversions keeps reporting honest and gives ad platforms the right signal.

• Fire conversions on success, not on button click, to avoid counting failed forms and payments.

• Using GA4 recommended event names saves setup time and unlocks built-in reports.

• A written tracking plan in Google Sheets keeps marketers, developers and analysts on the same page.